MACHINE LEARNING HACKATHON

OFFICIAL RULE BOOK

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1. COMPETITION OVERVIEW

The Machine Learning Hackathon is a two-round competition designed to evaluate participants on their **machine learning knowledge, problem-solving ability, technical implementation, and creativity**.

Competition Rounds

1. **Round 1 — Online Quiz**
2. **Round 2 — Offline Hackathon**

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2. ELIGIBILITY & TEAM FORMATION

2.1 Eligibility

- Open to **all college students**.

2.2 Team Size

- Each team may consist of a **maximum of 4 members**.
- Teams must be finalized before the beginning of Round 1.
- Each team must nominate **one representative** for communication with the organizers.

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3. ROUND 1 — ONLINE QUIZ

3.1 Format

- The quiz will be conducted **online**.
- The quiz will be **time-bound**.
- Questions will cover **core machine learning concepts**.
- The quiz must be completed in **one sitting**.

3.2 Rules

- Participants must complete the quiz independently.
- Use of **external assistance, bots, or AI tools** is prohibited.
- Any violation may result in disqualification.

3.3 Qualification

- Teams will be shortlisted based on their **cumulative quiz scores**.
- Qualified teams will proceed to Round 2.

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4. ROUND 2 — OFFLINE HACKATHON

4.1 Problem Statement

- A common problem statement will be announced in the presence of all qualified teams.
- The same challenge will be provided to all teams.

4.2 Development

- Teams will receive a **fixed duration** to develop their solution.
- Development work must be completed during the hackathon period.

4.3 Development Restrictions

- Pre-existing code may not be reused.
- Open-source libraries and frameworks are permitted.
- Public datasets are permitted.
- External resources or code used must be properly documented.

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5. PROJECT REQUIREMENTS

Every project must:

- Be **original**.
- Be developed during the hackathon.
- Address the given problem statement.
- Use machine learning appropriately.
- Follow ethical AI and responsible data practices.
- Clearly disclose external resources used.

Previous Work

Any continuation of previous work must be disclosed. Only the **new features or improvements** developed during the hackathon will be considered for evaluation.

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6. REQUIRED SUBMISSIONS

Each team must submit:

6.1 Project Code

- Complete project code.
- Proper documentation.
- GitHub repository.

6.2 Dataset

- Dataset(s) used.
- Source of each dataset.

6.3 Project Report

The report must include:

- Problem Statement
- Solution Approach
- Dataset(s) Used
- Model Architecture
- Evaluation Metrics
- Results & Analysis
- Real-World Application

6.4 Project Presentation

Teams must prepare presentation slides for the **final evaluation and demonstration**.

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7. EVALUATION CRITERIA

Criterion	Weightage
Technical Accuracy	**50%**
Innovation & Creativity	**20%**
Execution & Functionality	**15%**

Presentation (Documentation) & Clarity	**15%**
Total	**100%**

Technical Accuracy — 50%

Correctness, robustness, and technical quality of the ML implementation.

Innovation & Creativity — 20%

Originality and creativity of the proposed solution.

Execution & Functionality — 15%

Working prototype, code quality, and usability.

Git Hub repo and Documentation

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8. TIE-BREAKING

In the event of a tie:

Technical Accuracy will be used as the primary tie-breaking criterion.

The team with the stronger Technical Accuracy score will be ranked higher.

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9. SUBMISSION RULES

- Code must be submitted through the designated **GitHub repository**.
- The project report must be submitted in **PDF or Markdown format**.
- The presentation must be ready for final evaluation.
- All submissions must be completed before the announced submission deadline.
- **Late submissions will not be accepted.**

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10. PROHIBITED ACTIVITIES

The following are strictly prohibited:

- Use of bots or AI assistants during the quiz but in the offline round it is allowed but the participants should show which AI and why they used it.
- External assistance during the competition.
- Plagiarism or copying of another team's work.
- Reuse of pre-existing code, except permitted open-source libraries and frameworks.
- Misrepresentation of project work.
- Unsporting or unfair conduct.
- Violation of competition rules.

Any violation may result in **immediate disqualification** at the discretion of the organizers.

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11. CODE OF CONDUCT

Participants must:

- Maintain a respectful and inclusive environment.
- Behave professionally throughout the event.
- Respect fellow participants, organizers, and judges.

The following will not be tolerated:

- Harassment
- Discrimination
- Inappropriate behavior
- Unsporting conduct

Violations may result in **disqualification**.

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12. GENERAL RULES

- Organizers reserve the right to modify the competition rules when necessary.
- Organizers may disqualify teams for rule violations.
- The event may be modified or cancelled due to unforeseen circumstances.
- Official updates will be communicated by the organizers.
- Decisions of the **judging panel and organizing committee are final and binding**.

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13. PARTICIPATION AGREEMENT

By participating in the hackathon, all teams agree to follow the competition rules, submission requirements, project guidelines, code of conduct, and decisions of the organizing committee.